

EU to scrape through winter on tight gas reserves

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【メール原文】

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summary

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The EU will likely avoid emergency measures this winter, but below-floor gas storage leaves the bloc exposed to any supply shock or cold snap.
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The earthquake in Colombia will exacerbate fiscal challenges for President Abelardo De la Espriella's new government.
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US Secretary of State Marco Rubio's call for a gradual Cuban transition signals Washington is settling in for a long game, with a managed political deal more likely than swift regime change.
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Political pivots toward the West are paying off in Hungary and Poland, where equity markets are surging on EU fund inflows and renewed investor confidence.
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Regions, countries, and sectors covered in this edition include the US, Bolivia, Colombia, the EU, Hungary, Nigeria, Poland, Senegal, energy and oil.

the top line

EU, Energy—EU will likely scrape through winter on tighter gas reserves

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The EU will likely get through the 2026-2027 winter without resorting to emergency measures, but storage will land below the effective 80% floor, leaving the region exposed to supply disruptions or a cold snap.
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Title Transfer Facility (TTF) spot prices will likely average €45–€65 per megawatt hour through the end of March as Strait of Hormuz disruptions and below-seasonal storage keep the global gas market tight.
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The Russian LNG ban will likely take effect on 1 January 2027, removing 13%–15% of EU LNG imports with the unlikely prospect of a temporary waiver.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: ecr@eurasiagroup.net .

Colombia—Earthquake will exacerbate fiscal challenges

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A powerful earthquake that caused extensive damage and killed at least 240 people is set to increase fiscal pressure on De la Espriella's administration less than one week into its four-year term. The administration declared an economic emergency—a legal mechanism allowing the government to issue decrees to address the crisis and establish temporary taxes.

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Finance Minister Miguel Gomez has ruled out new taxes, saying funds will come from savings generated by cuts elsewhere in the budget and a \$450 million World Bank loan—but the administration also inherited a 30.2 trillion-peso (\$9.7 billion) shortfall in the 2027 budget that did not include earthquake-related costs, which congress must approve before 20 October.

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The disaster response will be De la Espriella's first major test. Although the administration has signaled a preference for spending cuts, tax increases may prove unavoidable given spending requirements.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: latinamerica@eurasiagroup.net .

Cuba, US—Rubio suggests a longer-term transition

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Rubio said Cuba would be on an "irreversible path towards a much different future" before President Donald Trump's term ends, but stressed change would require a gradual transition—comparing the process to Eastern European transitions that took three to five years. This signals Washington expects a prolonged process rather than immediate political change.

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Cuba remains a top foreign policy priority for Trump after Iran, but the US appears to recognize the absence of an obvious successor or opposition figure, pointing toward a more managed transition akin to Venezuela's, which is currently under interim President Delcy Rodriguez.

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Recent reports of expanded CIA intelligence and operational capabilities focused on Cuba suggest Washington is keeping multiple policy options open. Even so, the most likely outcome is a broader deal combining economic concessions with symbolic political change, with any military action expected to be limited.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: latinamerica@eurasiagroup.net .

Hungary, Poland—Chart of the day: Optimism drives equity gains among pro-Western Central European governments

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Stock indices in Hungary and Poland have gone up by 43% and 29% respectively this year, handily outperforming the STOXX Europe 600 Index's 12% gain.

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The political shifts to the West have been key drivers:

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Since Peter Magyar won Hungary's April elections, an expected change in policy (that has already started to manifest) and an agreement to unlock EU funds have fueled a broad rally, with the forint also appreciating significantly—especially relative to other Central European currencies.

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Poland's asset rally, meanwhile, rests on a stable trajectory for the current pro-Western government, solid long-term growth prospects, and the prospect of continued EU investments; next year's parliamentary election will be key for momentum behind the rise of Polish assets.

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Reach out to discuss: geoeconomics@eurasiagroup.net .

Nigeria, Oil—New fiscal incentives likely to spur oil investments in Nigeria

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President Bola Tinubu's administration enacted the Deep Offshore Oil and Gas Projects Incentives (Tax Remission) Order on 6 August, introducing production tax credits for Nigeria's deep offshore oil sector. The new standardized framework is likely to spur investment by removing the need for ad hoc, project-by-project negotiations.

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The order provides legal grounding for a \$11.50-per-barrel credit Tinubu's administration extended to Shell to secure a final investment decision—a binding commitment to deploy capital—on the long-delayed Bonga South-West project, the first offshore final investment decision since 2008. Formalizing that precedent into law signals a more predictable investment environment.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: africa@eurasiagroup.net .

upcoming conference calls

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13 August 10:00 AM ET—Analysing global oil & gas markets. Register here .

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14 August 8:00 AM ET—Brazil update (in Portuguese). Register here .

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14 August 10:30 AM ET—Brazil update (in English). Register here .

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17 August 12:30 AM ET—India update. Register here .

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18 August 9:30 AM ET—China's political and economic outlook. Register here .

eg in depth

Bolivia—Investment law will open the way for sectoral overhauls

President Rodrigo Paz's administration presented a long-awaited investment reform to congress on 11 August. The bill creates a national investment agency, requires congressional approval for the nationalization of companies. More controversial articles, such as the return of international arbitration bodies, are likely to generate backlash that could push the administration to dilute those measures (see note : 31 July). Lawmakers are likely to support the bill, though the road to approval will likely be bumpy and will entail difficult negotiations. Read more here . Reach out to discuss: latinamerica@eurasiagroup.net .

Senegal—A local election delay would improve prospects for Faye's party

Last week, Aminata Toure, general supervisor of President Diomaye Faye's new party, Kiiraay, said that the upcoming local elections could take place at any point in 2027. The constitutional council will likely have to resolve the timing dispute. If it accepts Toure's interpretation, Kiiraay would probably gain an advantage in the local elections because the new party would have more time to organize and mobilize. Read more here . Reach out to discuss: africa@eurasiagroup.net .

Upcoming events:

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13 August: Events: Zambia holds presidential and parliamentary elections; UK Clacton parliamentary by-election is held following Reform Leader Nigel Farage's decision to quit as an MP and recontest the seat; Data: Argentina CPI, US PPI; Central bank decision: Peru.

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14 August: Data: Eurozone GDP and unemployment; US retail sales, business inventories, University of Michigan consumer sentiment, France, Poland, and Israel CPI.

The EG Daily Brief is compiled by Jens Larsen, Lucy Eve, Babak Minovi, Pietro Guglielmi, Rahul Bhatia, Marilia Sirio, Martina Silva, and Trista Kelley, with help from Astral Betteridge and Blaise Hanson.

closing quip

"Despite the military might of the United States, the international communist movement does not back down; it resists and stands up to it."—Miguel Mario Diaz-Canel Bermudez, President of Cuba, said in an address on 9 August.

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